

Principles of Microeconomics

ECON 2020 • Fall 2026

TR 3:30 PM – 4:45 PM • Foy Hall 258

Instructor: Yushang Wei
Office: 109D Miller Hall
Email: Send all emails through Canvas
Head GTA: Richard Adewole
Office Hours: Monday and Wednesday, 3:30–8:00 p.m., Miller 201
Webpage: Canvas (auburn.instructure.com)

Communication and Help Sessions

Please send all emails through Canvas. **Richard Adewole** is our head GTA for the Fall 2026 semester and will address or answer most of the questions that a student may have about the class. In case the head GTA cannot answer the question or assist with the issue, he will forward the email to the professor. All emails will be answered within 48 hours.

Help sessions and office hours are held **Monday and Wednesday, 3:30–8:00 p.m. in Miller 201**, by both graduate and undergraduate TAs. ALL make-up tests will also be administered on these two days during these specific hours.

How to Message the GTA in Canvas

Send your questions to Richard using the **Canvas Inbox** (also called Conversations):

1. In the global navigation menu on the far left of Canvas, click **Inbox** (the envelope icon).
2. Click the **Compose** icon (pencil/paper) at the top of the Inbox.
3. In the **Course** drop-down, choose **ECON 2020 (Fall 2026)**.
4. Click the address-book icon next to the **To** field, select the **Teaching Assistants** group, then click **Richard Adewole** (or simply type “Richard” in the To field and pick his name).
5. Write a clear subject line — for example, “ECON 2020 — MyEconLab homework question” — then your message, and click **Send**.

For a fast reply: always include your full name and section number, keep the subject line specific, and allow up to 48 hours for a response. To be alerted by email when Richard replies, go to **Account** → **Notifications** in Canvas, find **Conversations** → “**Conversation Message**,” and set it to **Notify me right away**. The Canvas Inbox is also the right place for personal questions about grades, make-ups, and accommodations.

Course Description

This is an introductory course in Microeconomics designed to introduce the student to economic principles emphasizing scarcity and choice, supply and demand, markets, consumption and production, globalization of markets, role of government, and market failure.

Course Objectives

Upon completion of the course, you should be able to:

1. Use economic concepts to help make decisions in real-life scenarios.
2. Use positive analysis while reading about current events and while describing relationships between economic variables.
3. Analyze events in the marketplace for many different types of goods and services.

Course Materials

- **Required:** E-textbook: *Microeconomics*, 9th ed., R. Glenn Hubbard and Anthony P. O'Brien.
- **Required:** MyEconLab account. MyEconLab can be accessed through Canvas (look for the “MyEconLab” tab on the left once you enter the course on Canvas). MyEconLab is now a part of AllAccess and students will be charged through e-bill for it (no need to pay with a credit card when registering).

You do not need to go to the bookstore to purchase these materials. Both the e-textbook and MyEconLab are already part of **AllAccess**, and you will be billed automatically through e-bill — there is nothing to buy separately and no credit card is needed at registration.

Note on MyEconLab access: the MyEconLab link is still being set up and will be available during the **first week of classes**. I will post a Canvas announcement as soon as it is ready, so please make sure your Canvas notifications are turned on. You are not expected to complete any MyEconLab work before that announcement goes out.

How to Access Your Textbook

Once I post the announcement that the link is live, follow these steps:

1. Log in to Canvas at auburn.instructure.com and open our ECON 2020 course.
2. In the course navigation menu on the left, click the **MyEconLab** tab.
3. Sign in with your Pearson account, or create one if this is your first Pearson course. Use your **Auburn email address** so your account matches our roster.
4. When prompted for payment, choose the **AllAccess** option. Do *not* enter a credit card — the charge goes to your e-bill automatically.
5. Open the e-textbook from inside MyEconLab. You can read it online or use the Pearson eText app on a phone or tablet.

If something goes wrong: contact **Pearson support** first — they handle account, login, and access-code problems, and they can see things on their end that I cannot. If the issue is still unresolved after contacting Pearson, message the head GTA through the Canvas Inbox (steps are under “Communication and Help Sessions” above) and tell us what Pearson said.

Prerequisites

No formal prerequisite for this class.

Instructional / Teaching Method

This is an in-person course that is delivered in a classroom during a 16-week period. Canvas and MyEconLab will be used to post reading material, class notes, and practice problems for this course. Students are responsible for checking Canvas announcements. Weekly announcements will be posted every Monday morning regarding what to expect that week, what to be working on, and any upcoming due dates. Additional Canvas announcements may be posted throughout the week regarding class cancellations, changes to exam dates, and more. Please ensure all notifications for Canvas announcements are turned on in your settings on Canvas.

There will be four midterm exams and an optional final exam in this class.

Course Structure

The course will follow this general pattern:

- At the start of each chapter, students will familiarize themselves with the learning outcomes for the chapter.
- Students will attend lectures on Tuesdays and Thursdays from 3:30 PM–4:45 PM in Foy Hall 258. The textbook in this course is a supplement to the lectures.
- Throughout each chapter, students will be sure to attend office hours or email/message the instructor if a concept is unclear.
- At the end of each chapter, students will work through practice quizzes and additional practice problems to review class content and prepare for exams.
- According to the schedule below, students will take an exam comprised of 30 multiple choice questions after covering several chapters in class.

Grading Policy

Your course average will be computed in **two different ways**. I will calculate both and **keep whichever gives you the higher grade** — you do not have to choose, and you cannot lose by doing well late in the semester. The second method exists specifically to reward students who improve a lot by the end of the course.

Method 1 — Four Equally Weighted Exams

Your average is the four regular-semester exams, worth **25% each**. At the end of the semester, you may replace your one lowest exam score with your score on the **optional** cumulative final exam (Monday, December 7th at 1:30 PM, as set by the university's final exam schedule). If your final exam score is lower than your scores on Exams 1–4, it will not count toward (and will not lower) your grade.

Component	Weight
Exam One	25%
Exam Two	25%
Exam Three	25%
Exam Four	25%
Total	100%

(The optional final may replace your one lowest exam score in this method.)

Method 2 — Improvement Weighted

Your average is built mostly from the cumulative final exam. Your **lowest** of the four regular-semester exams is **dropped**, and the remaining three count for 30% in total (10% each).

Component	Weight
Cumulative final exam	70%
Best three of Exams 1–4 (lowest dropped)	30%
Total	100%

Putting the Two Methods Together

I will compute your average under both methods and your course grade will be based on the **higher** of the two. Because Method 2 leans so heavily on the final, a student who starts slowly but masters the material by December can still earn a strong grade. If you choose not to take the final exam, Method 1 simply applies.

In addition, up to **5% extra credit** is available through in-class bonus questions and selected MyLab Economics homework (see below); this extra credit is added on top of whichever course average is higher, and your total bonus is capped at 5% no matter how much you earn across the two sources. There will be no make-up exams, except in cases of documented medical or necessary school-related absence. See below for more information about make-up exams. Final grades are non-negotiable.

Added to your course average either way	
Bonus (in-class questions + selected MyLab homework)	up to +5%

Extra Credit (Bonus)

There are **two ways** to earn bonus credit in this course:

1. **In-class bonus questions.** During lectures we will have some in-class questions administered through MyEconLab. Participating in these earns bonus credit.
2. **Selected MyLab Economics homework.** Certain homework assignments will be designated as bonus assignments. Completing them earns bonus credit. I will announce on Canvas which assignments count.

Your total bonus is capped at 5%. The opportunities offered across both sources may add up to *more* than 5% over the semester, but at most **5 percentage points** will ever be added to your course average. For example, if you earn the full 5% from in-class questions *and* the full 5% from bonus homework, the amount added to your average is still 5% — not 10%.

Bonus source	Counts toward the cap
In-class bonus questions (during lecture)	yes
Selected MyLab Economics homework	yes
Maximum added to your course average	+5%

Because the two sources overlap, having more chances than you need is deliberate: if you miss

some in-class questions, the bonus homework can still carry you to the full 5%, and the other way around.

There is NO make-up for the in-class bonus. Even if you are absent for a documented reason (for example, illness), you cannot make up missed in-class questions. Bonus homework must be submitted through MyLab Economics by its posted due date; late submissions do not earn bonus credit.

The final grading scale is as follows:

Letter Grade	Numerical Grade
A	89.5–100
B	79.5–89.4
C	69.5–79.4
D	59.5–69.4
F	59.4 and below

Exam Policy

There will be 4 midterm exams and an optional final exam. ALL exams are in-person and will be administered in our regular classroom. You will only have one attempt for each exam. Each of the four midterm exams will consist of 30 multiple choice questions. Please bring a photo ID, pencil, and calculator on all exam days.

You may bring a **one-page cheat sheet** to each exam, subject to the following rules:

- Letter size only (8.5 by 11 inches), and **one side only**.
- It must be **hand-written**. Printed, photocopied, or typed sheets are not permitted.
- **Internet-connected devices will not be allowed during exams.**

Name, ID, and version must all be filled out on the bubble sheet before it is turned in, or there will be a 5-point penalty. Exam grades will be posted on Canvas. Exams will not be returned, but an answer key will be posted on Canvas until the start of finals week. You may go over the specific questions you missed during my help sessions/office hours.

Exam Day Checklist

Before each exam, make sure you:

1. Arrive on time.
2. Bring a calculator (calculators are allowed).
3. Print your own bubble sheet — you can find the bubble sheet on Canvas.
4. Bring your Student ID.
5. Bring your cheat sheet.

Optional Cumulative Final Exam

On Monday, December 7th between 1:30 PM and 3:30 PM, you will have the opportunity to take an optional cumulative final exam. It is *optional* in that you are not required to take the final exam, and your grade will not be affected if you choose not to take it. It is *cumulative* in that it covers the material from the entire semester, and you will have 120 minutes to complete the exam.

The final exam feeds into *both* grading methods described under Grading Policy. Under Method 1, a final exam score higher than any of your Exams 1–4 replaces your one lowest exam score. Under Method 2, the final counts for 70% of your average, with the best three of your four exams making up the other 30%. Because I always keep the higher of the two results, **taking the optional cumulative final exam cannot hurt your grade** — a poor final simply means Method 1 (without substitution) is the one that counts. If you skip the final entirely, Method 1 applies and your grade is unaffected. As with the 4 regular semester exams, please bring a photo ID, pencil, and calculator on all exam days. Name, ID, and version must all be filled out on the bubble sheet before it is turned in, or there will be a 5-point penalty.

Make-up Exams

There will be no make-up exams, except in cases of documented medical or necessary school-related absence. Students must inform the instructor in advance (before or on exam day) that they will need to take the make-up exam. Notifying the instructor after the exam closes will result in a zero on the exam. Final grades are non-negotiable. ALL make-up exams will be administered during help sessions/office hours — Monday and Wednesday, 3:30–8:00 p.m. in Miller 201 (see p. 1 of the syllabus). A student has to bring a hard copy of their excuse when they come to take the make-up exam. As per AU policy, all make-ups should be taken within ONE WEEK of the missed exam. Students should send a request to the head GTA, Richard Adewole, through Canvas to schedule their make-up exam during help sessions/office hours.

This make-up policy applies to exams only. There are **no make-ups for the in-class bonus questions** that count toward extra credit — not even for a documented absence. See “Extra Credit (Bonus)” under Grading Policy.

Exam Schedule

Exam	Date	Location	Time
Exam 1	Thursday, September 10	Foy Hall 258	3:30 PM–4:45 PM
Exam 2	Tuesday, October 6	Foy Hall 258	3:30 PM–4:45 PM
Exam 3	Thursday, October 29	Foy Hall 258	3:30 PM–4:45 PM
Exam 4	Thursday, December 3	Foy Hall 258	3:30 PM–4:45 PM
Optional Final	Monday, December 7	Foy Hall 258	1:30 PM–3:30 PM

There is NO make-up final exam.

Attendance

Students are encouraged to attend every lecture. Copies of the slides will be available on Canvas before each lecture, as well as other study material and information regarding exam dates. If you wish to have a hard copy of the PowerPoints, it is your responsibility to print them off. I will not provide copies of the class notes.

Academic Honesty

All exams are closed book and closed notes, with the single exception of the hand-written one-page cheat sheet described under Exam Policy above. Looking at your phone during an exam, conferring with others during an exam, and using your book or any notes other than your permitted cheat sheet during an exam are all examples of cheating that will result in my giving you a zero as your exam score. All portions of the Auburn University student academic honesty code (Title XII) found in the Student Policy eHandbook will apply to university courses. All academic honesty violations or alleged violations of the SGA Code of Laws will be reported to the Office of the Provost, which will then refer the case to the Academic Honesty Committee.

Policy on Classroom Behavior

The goal of Auburn University and its faculty and students is to foster a dynamic environment of higher learning where all students develop analytical skills, learn to think critically, and communicate effectively, promote inquiry, pursue knowledge, and prepare for productive careers. Behavior in the classroom that impedes teaching and learning and creates obstacles to this goal is considered disruptive and therefore subject to sanctions. The purpose of these sanctions is to create and protect an optimum learning experience; they should not be considered punitive, neither by the student nor by the instructor. Disagreement expressed in a civil fashion, eccentricity, idiosyncrasy, and unconventional behavior are not, per se, disruptive to the classroom experience. These sanctions are intended only to preserve the classroom as a place to pursue knowledge, exchange ideas, and share opinions in an atmosphere of tolerance.

Students have the responsibility of complying with behavioral standards. Faculty members have a professional responsibility to set reasonable limits on the expression of opinions while treating students with dignity, respect, and understanding while guiding classroom activities. At the classroom level, clear guidelines for behavior and early intervention are the foundation for an intellectually stimulating experience for students and instructors alike. Instructors are encouraged to include in their syllabi guidelines for classroom behavior. Instructors who state these guidelines early and enforce them at the first appearance of disruptive behavior prevent minor episodes of classroom misconduct from escalating into serious confrontations and help transgressors to avoid the more serious consequences of such actions.

Examples of improper behavior in the classroom (including the virtual classroom of e-mail, chat rooms, telephony, and web activities associated with courses) may include, but are not limited to, the following:

1. Arriving after a class has begun (if you are running late, please be quiet and find a seat without disturbing your classmates);
2. Use of tobacco products;
3. Monopolizing discussion;
4. Persistent speaking out of turn;
5. Distractive talking, including cell phone usage (please set cell phones and laptops to silent mode);
6. Audio or video recording of classroom activities or the use of electronic devices without the permission of the instructor;

7. Refusal to comply with reasonable instructor directions;
8. Employing insulting language or gestures;
9. Verbal, psychological, or physical threats, harassment, and physical violence;
10. Please avoid eating foods with strong odors during the lecture, as it can disturb your classmates. If you are really hungry, consider having an energy bar, candy, or chocolate instead. Any food that may disturb the study environment is not permitted.

When confronted with disruptive but non-threatening behavior, the instructor should issue a general word of caution to the class as a whole rather than to a particular student so as not to exacerbate the problem. If a general caution directed to the entire class does not stop the disruptive activity, the instructor should endeavor to meet in private with the disruptive student. The resulting discussion should include a description of the problem, the reason it is disruptive, and the consequences of continued violations of classroom behavior guidelines. If the disruptive behavior is preventing further instruction, the instructor is authorized to ask the disruptive student to leave the class immediately for the remainder of the class session.

Removal from the classroom for more than one class period, for an extended period, or on a permanent basis normally requires the instructor to file charges of a violation of the Auburn University Code of Student Conduct with the Vice President for Student Affairs. The department head/chair or dean may negotiate a withdrawal from the course or a transfer of the disruptive student to a different course section or course, if, in his or her opinion, a different instructor and different classmates would diffuse the situation and provide the disruptive student with a new learning opportunity. If threats have been made or physical violence is imminent, the instructor should notify the Auburn University Department of Campus Safety & Security immediately. The instructor should also notify the course department head/chair or dean promptly, followed by a memo to the department head/chair or dean.

Calculator

A basic scientific calculator will be allowed on all tests. An app on your phone cannot be used as a calculator. Graphing calculators are not permitted. Sharing calculators is not permitted.

Accessibility Accommodations

Students who need accommodations are asked to electronically submit their approved accommodations through AU Access and to arrange a meeting during office hours the first week of classes, or as soon as possible if accommodations are needed immediately. If you have a conflict with my office hours, an alternate time can be arranged. To set up this meeting, please contact me by e-mail. If you have not established accommodations through the Office of Accessibility, but need accommodations, make an appointment with the Office of Accessibility, 1228 Haley Center, 844-2096.

Anticipated Course Outline

Date	Material, Activities, etc.
Aug. 18	Syllabus
Aug. 20	Chapter 1: Introduction
Aug. 25	Chapter 3: Supply and Demand
Aug. 27	Chapter 3: Supply and Demand
Sept. 1	Chapter 3: Supply and Demand
Sept. 3	Chapter 4: Consumer and Producer Surplus
Sept. 8	Chapter 4: Consumer and Producer Surplus
Sept. 10	Exam #1
Sept. 15	Chapter 4: Price Controls and Taxes
Sept. 17	Chapter 4: Price Controls and Taxes
Sept. 22	Chapter 5: Externalities and Public Goods
Sept. 24	Chapter 5: Externalities and Public Goods
Sept. 29	Chapter 6: Elasticity
Oct. 1	Chapter 6: Elasticity
Oct. 6	Exam #2
Oct. 8	Fall Break (No Class)
Oct. 13	Chapter 2: PPFs and Comparative Advantage
Oct. 15	Chapters 2 and 9: PPFs and Comparative Advantage; International Trade
Oct. 20	Chapter 9: International Trade
Oct. 22	Chapter 11: Costs
Oct. 27	Chapter 11: Costs
Oct. 29	Exam #3
Nov. 3	Chapter 12: Perfect Competition
Nov. 5	Chapter 12: Perfect Competition
Nov. 10	Chapter 15: Monopoly
Nov. 12	Chapter 13: Monopolistic Competition
Nov. 17	Chapter 14: Oligopoly
Nov. 19	Chapter 10: Consumer Behavior
Nov. 24–28	Thanksgiving Break (No Class)
Dec. 1	Chapter 10: Consumer Behavior
Dec. 3	Exam #4
Monday, Dec. 7, 1:30 PM	Optional Cumulative Final Exam

Syllabus Changes

I reserve the right to change the course syllabus, exam dates, and course outline. If changes are made to the syllabus or exam dates, adequate notice will be provided via both Canvas and in-class announcements.